

DSA in Java Using Kunal Kushwaha - Complete Study Guide

Why this roadmap?

Use Kunal Kushwaha for concepts, Striver A2Z Sheet for structured practice, and LeetCode for interview-level problems. Focus on Java throughout.

Step 1: Learn the Concept

Watch one Kunal Kushwaha video. Pause often, type every line of code yourself, understand why it works, and make notes.

Step 2: Code Everything Yourself

Do not copy-paste. Watch a small portion, pause, code it, run it, compare with the video, and debug any mistakes.

Step 3: Solve Every Question from the Video

After finishing the lesson, solve every practice problem shown in the video on your own.

Step 4: Practice with Striver A2Z Sheet

Open the matching topic and solve all Easy problems before moving to Medium.

Step 5: Practice on LeetCode

Never choose random problems. Pick problems from the same topic you just learned. Solve Easy first, then Medium, then Hard if needed.

How to Identify the Topic

nums[] -> Arrays; head -> Linked List; root -> Trees; string s -> Strings; matrix -> 2D Arrays; graph/edges -> Graphs.

How to Approach Any Problem

1. Read carefully.
2. Understand the input.
3. Understand the expected output.
4. Dry-run the sample manually.
5. Think of a brute-force solution first.
6. Implement it.
7. Optimize using the appropriate data structure or algorithm.

If You Get Stuck (20-20-20 Rule)

First 20 minutes: Think and try yourself.

Next 20 minutes: Read only hints.

Last 20 minutes: Watch one explanation, then close it and solve again from scratch.

If You Still Can't Solve

Watch the solution, close it, wait a while, and then re-implement it without looking. Retry the next day if needed.

Never Memorize Code

Memorize patterns and ideas, not syntax. Ask why a HashMap, Stack, Queue, Two Pointers, or Binary Search works.

Attempts Strategy

Spend 30–45 minutes first. Use hints if needed. If necessary, watch the solution, re-code it, solve again the next day, and revisit after one week.

Questions Per Topic

Easy: 8–15, Medium: 10–20, Hard: 0–5 (optional during placements).

Daily Schedule

Session 1 (60–90 min): Learn from Kunal.

Session 2 (60 min): Solve video questions.

Session 3 (60–90 min): Solve 3–5 LeetCode/Striver problems and review mistakes.

Recommended Topic Order

Java Basics, Time & Space Complexity, Arrays, Linear Search, Binary Search, Sorting, Strings, Recursion, Backtracking, Linked Lists, Stacks, Queues, Trees, BST, Heaps, Hashing, Sliding Window, Two Pointers, Greedy, Graphs, Dynamic Programming.

Maintain a DSA Journal

For every problem record:

- Problem
- Pattern
- Mistake
- Key Idea

Example:

Problem: Two Sum

Pattern: HashMap

Mistake: Sorting lost original indices.

Key Idea: Store value → index while iterating.